Introduction and Purpose of the Software

The Inventory Management System is a simple program that helps store employees keep track of products, stock levels, and customer purchases. The software allows you to see what items are in stock, process sales, add new products, remove old ones, and get alerts when items are running low. This manual will show you how to use every feature step by step.

Installation and Setup Instructions

Double click the file named InventorySystem.exe to launch the program. A black window will open showing the main menu with four options. If you do not have the .exe file, open the project in Visual Studio and press Ctrl Shift B to build it. The program does not need internet access or any additional software to run. To close the program at any time, select option 4 from the main menu.

Step by Step Usage Instructions

When the program starts, you will see a menu with four options. Type the number of your choice and press Enter.

To make a purchase, select option 1. You will see a list of all products with their ID numbers, prices, and how many are in stock. Type the ID of the product you want to buy and press Enter. Then type how many you want to purchase and press Enter. The program will show you the total cost and update the stock count automatically.

To view your current inventory, select option 2 from the main menu. This screen shows every product in the system along with its price and current stock level. Any item that is low on stock will have a LOW STOCK warning next to it. Press Enter to return to the main menu.

To add a new product, select option 3 to enter the edit inventory menu, then select option 1. The program will ask for the product name, price, initial quantity, and a reorder threshold. The reorder threshold is the stock level that will trigger a low stock alert. After entering all the information, the product will be added to your inventory.

To remove a product, select option 3, then option 2. You will see a list of all products with their ID numbers. Type the ID of the product you want to remove and press Enter. The product will be deleted from the system.

To exit the program, select option 4 from the main menu at any time.

Visual Description of Program Screens

The main menu displays a box with four numbered options in the center of the screen. The register screen shows a table with columns for product ID, name, price, and stock quantity. When a low stock alert appears, it shows a warning message below the inventory table listing which items need to be reordered.

Troubleshooting Guide

If you type a number that is not an option, the program will say invalid option and ask you to try again. Simply type a correct number between 1 and 4.

If you try to purchase more of an item than what is in stock, the program will show an error message and the purchase will not go through. Check the current stock level before trying again.

If the program displays strange characters where boxes should be, the program will still work correctly. This is a display issue with your console window.

If you cannot find a product you thought you added, go to order tab to see the full inventory list. Make sure you completed all the steps when adding the product.

Frequently Asked Questions

What does reorder threshold mean? The reorder threshold is the lowest amount of stock you want to have before being alerted. For example if you set the threshold to 5, the program will warn you when stock drops to 5 or below so you know it is time to order more.

How do I change the price of a product? The program does not have a direct price edit option. To change a price, remove the product and add it again with the new price.

Does the program save my inventory after I close it? No. When you close the program, all changes will be lost. The next time you open it, the default products will be there.

What do I do when I see a low stock alert? The alert means you are running low on that item. You should order more from your supplier. The program does not automatically order for you.

Can more than one person use this program at the same time? No. The program is designed for one user at a time on a single computer.

How do I restock an item that is already in the system? Add the product again with the same name. It will create a new entry with its own ID. Remove the old low stock entry if you want only one listing.

What if I accidentally remove the wrong product? You cannot undo a removal. You will need to add the product back manually with all its information.